

SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE, Model: KHALIDA (ESKIMO MODELS)

been lured to northern shores "in search of new opportunities". The newest additions to the WIFW roster also include names like Amit GT, Azara, Charu Parasher, Ekru by Ekta Jaipuria and Ruchira Kandhari, Khushali Kumar, Rahul Reddy, Ankur and Priyanka Modi, Atsu Sekhose, Aruna Singh and Amishi Dhanuka.

And the new buzzwords being whispered in ateliers are understated luxury. While fabrics like taffeta, silk satin, velvet, cashmere and jacquard attempt to weigh down spring-summer's fanciful romanticism, this autumn-winter is also about lofty ideas, deeper hues and structured silhouettes. So while Cue duo Gandhi and Khanna employ "structured lines, modulated fittings and clever twists" in their line *Lost in an Urban Maze*, a comment on the modern urban sprawl, newbie Prashant Verma pays a James Dean-esque tribute to the "aggression of youth" and its rebellion in *Giant*. Bahl's India 2008 is bathed in black, deep reds, blues and greens and attempts to "look beyond the brocades, paisleys and saris". Payal Jain's

exactly which shows and stalls to go to. Why should they have to sift through Indian wear stalls sitting next to the ones selling swimwear?" he reasons. Payal Jain believes not only will the demarcation help buyers but designers will also be able to identify their own positioning. "It is important for young designers to recognise their own market and where they fit in," says Jain.

If the promise of a more organised and fuss-free event isn't enough, FDCI has more trump cards up its sleeves. From the Boston-based store Alan Bilzerian (its eponymous owner introduced Yohji Yamamoto and Issey Miyaki to America) and the chic Californian store Anastasia to Milanese specialty boutique Biffi, top-brass fashion consultant Benedict Bro and fashion publicist Karla Otto—some big fashion names are being touted. "Agents are very important to the designer because they have a multiplying effect. When you target a buyer you target one entity. But one agent can be associated with 20 buyers," says Nair. Add to these names, buyers like Bloomingdales (US), Boho London, Fred Segal

SURILY GOEL A Creator line, the sporty yet elegant collection is an ode to the global modern woman.

"The accent will be on subdued abstract embroideries as well as geometric prints this season."

J.J. VALAYA Paiza is the new ready-to-wear Valaya Base collection, under the Synthesis category.

"Structured silhouettes with fitted lowers and contradictions in fabrics and textures will be a big trend."

(California), Galeries Lafayette (Paris), Beams (Tokyo), Flower 4 U (Germany), H. Lorenzo (US), Henri Bendel (New York), Jashanmal and Partners Ltd (Dubai)—and the bait is big enough to reel them in.

And they sure are reeling them in. Lakme Fashion Week find Nitin Bal Chauhan has joined the WIFW clan. While international designer duo Hemant Sagar and Didier Lecoanet have taken their label Lecoanet Hemant to Delhi this season, Mumbai-based designer Gayatri Khanna has



BANDEEP SINGH